

Chapter 20 Lab: Report Writing Workshop

Getting Started on Your Research Report

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1 Overview

This chapter supports the report writing workshop. By this point Gordon has returned your analysed data — now you need to write it up as a complete Research Report.

2 Getting Started

2.1 What You Have

- Your analysed data (from Gordon)
- All your project documents (Information Sheet, Procedure, etc.)
- The project articles and background reading
- APA reporting guidelines from Week 19

2.2 Writing Order

Don't write the report front-to-back. Instead:

1. **Method** — you already have everything you need (participants, design, materials, procedure)
2. **Results** — use your analysed data; report descriptive and inferential statistics in APA format
3. **Introduction** — build the argument for your hypothesis using the suggested readings and your own research
4. **Discussion** — interpret your results, connect to theory, discuss limitations
5. **Abstract** — write this last, once everything else is done

3 Key Reminders

3.1 Results Section

- Report M and SD for each condition
- Report the inferential test (t-test) in APA format: $t(df) = X.XX, p = .XXX$
- State whether the result was significant at $\alpha = .05$
- Include a figure (e.g., bar chart with error bars) if appropriate
- State whether the hypothesis was supported

3.2 Discussion Section

- Start by restating your main finding in plain language (no statistics)
- Explain what the finding means in the context of the theory
- Compare to previous research — does your result agree or disagree?
- Be honest about limitations (sample size, materials, design)
- Suggest what future research could investigate
- End with a brief conclusion

4 Additional Resources

- Project Toolkit — your document reference
- Week 19 lecture reading — APA results reporting guidelines
- Week 20 lecture slides — discussion section writing guidance